

with Evernote as it's made by the same developers. Figure 2 shows a screenshot that has been edited using Skitch. I wanted to highlight the *Share* button in Wunderlist; and by taking a screenshot of the app and opening it in Skitch, I accomplished an activity that could have taken a phone call. I created some markups to highlight the area and just used the *Share* button to send that image as an attachment to an email. All in less than two minutes! You can highlight a picture from the Web or on maps and attach it to your note in Evernote. So if your note is shared with a colleague, you don't have to go out of your way to send an email; it simply syncs!

Staying connected

Imagine a day when you are travelling far from work and your client drops by unannounced at your office. And he wants to meet you right away to discuss his ongoing project. What do you do? You might be 2,000 kilometres away, with nothing but your phone and you want to help him. Luckily, Android has some apps that can get you out of this sticky situation. Skype is one of the most popular apps, which helps you have a face-to-face conversation with a person anywhere in the world. Audio chatting, video chatting and just a messenger are some of the features of Skype. You can make calls to another person logged onto Skype. However, what you can additionally do is call mobiles and landlines from this app. Summing up all its features, it works exactly like Skype installed on your desktop.

Teamviewer is another amazing application, which actually lets you share screens. So you could be continents away and still access all your files located in your desktop back at the office or home. It also lets you sync your device to your desktop. So you can not only access files, you can take control of your PC sitting far away.

In certain situations, you may want just one IM app that has several messengers included in it. The *IMO* is one such app, which can be customised and turned into a social IM or an office IM. It is one of the most appreciated apps in the press. It supports GTalk, Facebook chat, Yahoo Messenger and Jabber, among others. Thus, office chats that have been built on Jabber technology can be accessed after office hours, on holidays and while travelling, via IMO. Additionally, IMO has a long list of features such as free voice and video calling, document sharing, photos and voice messages, and an open chat room where you can meet other people using IMO. Besides, the app is extremely clever and finds news and information related to your broadcast. Besides IMO, the Play Store has a long list of chat apps such as Facebook, Yahoo! eBuddy Messenger, Hangouts, Xabber, etc. However, IMO has been recognised as the best app designed specially for Android devices.

Android devices have several apps such as Gmail, Yahoo! and Rediffmail, where we can access all our personal mails. There are several email clients

available for your device, but *K-9 mail* is one of the best email solutions for Android devices. More importantly, it is an open source app, and has some excellent features such as search, multi-folder synchronisation, signatures and much more. It supports Exchange 2003 and 2007, POP3 and IMAP. Its functions are almost equivalent to any email client on your desktop and support multiple accounts on the same app. With the help of this app, you can access office mails sitting at any location.

Your own Jarvis?

Tony Stark had an artificially intelligent computer named Jarvis in the Iron Man comics. As kids, when we saw that, we all wanted a Jarvis of our own. Guess what? With the recent advances in technology, you can have your own personal assistant on Android! One that can actually help you organise your day, remind you of important appointments, meetings and birthdays, search for nearby places, give weather updates, etc. In fact, it does just about anything short of actually building the Iron Man suit.

After the inclusion of Siri in iPhone, one saw a lot of developers trying to recreate that magic on Android. For those who are constantly on the go, Android has some really fantastic voice assistant apps. *Speaktoit* is one of the most widely used voice assistants on Android devices. It does the basic function of any voice-integrated app to find information that you want. However, this app has some very unique features and is not simply a clone of Apple's voice assistant. This app will remember your voice, the way you talk and adapt to your style.

Skyvi is another very popular voice assistant app and does everything, including making conversation with you and even cracking jokes!

If for some reason you do not get along with the *Speaktoit* assistant, there are several other personal assistants to choose from at the store for Android devices. You have Jeannie, Maluuba, Eva and Iris, among a host of others. Personal assistants truly allow you to enjoy your device in handsfree mode. Maluuba deserves a special mention here, as it matches well with users on the Indian sub-continent.

Smartphones and tablets can be a replacement for bulky laptops in the coming few years. And as we have seen in this article, a lot of your work can be automated or be accomplished in a very short time if you use the perfect set of apps that tightly integrate with each other. This greatly increases your productivity and also makes your experience with Android more interesting. 

By: Sharmishtha Jatar

The author is an open source enthusiast who loves to read on science and technology. A science student herself, she has spent hours tinkering with several Linux distributions as well as Android and wishes to share her knowledge in the true spirit of open source.